

**Dan Egan**

Chapters 3–4

WEEK 1 · WED 16 SEP

WATER QUESTION

An afternoon beside a lake, river, or ocean: which would you choose?

Fox River again. I actually looked up what lives in it, not just where it goes.

ARCHIVING What is here? Facts, ideas, style highlights.

Ch 3 - Tanner picks coho over lake trout in 1964. Trout don't fight hard, he says. 1966 Platte River release, chinook added 1967. By 1968 planted in all 5 lakes. Salmon crash on L. Huron 2000s once wild reproduction way outran hatchery math. Ch 4 - zebra mussel found by a grad student, Lake St Clair, 1988. Ballast water. Quagga found 1989, worse: no hard surface needed, filters year round, 540 ft deep. STYLE: Applegate = oncologist, Tanner = plastic surgeon. Cure vs. cosmetic fix. Cancer/X-ray language returns for mussels too - metastasize, telltale speck. Cuyahoga burned in 1868, ignored. Burned again in 1969 and made the news.

ANALYZING What does it mean? Who cares, who doesn't, who should care?

Ch 3 answers my ch 1-2 suspicion. P.78 Egan actually lists 'Native American tribes' as one of the bodies with a say over the lakes, same sentence as townships and the feds. Then next line: no referendum, no debate, one man decided alone. He names them then drops them in the same breath. Not an oversight, it's the evidence. Also every 'fix' becomes a bigger fix. Salmon fixes alewives, breaks lake trout recovery. Ballast rules fix nothing bc every loophole survives intact.

EXTENDING What does this tell us about our world right here and now?

The Cuyahoga fire happened twice, 100 yrs apart, and nothing changed til the 2nd time was politically useful. We still wait for the useful moment instead of the first warning. Ballast rules from the 90s still have the same loophole today. I keep hearing 'if' when it should be 'when' - that's basically what Green says at the very end of ch 4.

DISCUSSION What helpful questions can we ask about this work?

If Egan can name tribes as stakeholders in one sentence, why can't he ever come back to what they'd actually say about 'their' lake?
Is 'a good idea, but they overdid it' fair to Tanner, or too easy on him?

VOCABULARY WORDS

ballast · veligers · byssal threads
Secchi depth · shifting baseline · jack (fish)

FEELINGS EVOKED

wants triumph first (coho miracle), then body-horror creep w/ the mussels. On me: suspicion again, now with a specific page.

